

Guidelines for the preparation of Examination Papers

- Examination papers must be typed under secure conditions and disks and master copies kept locked away after use.
- Papers should be typed/printed in the format shown on the template attached.
- The print should be sufficiently dark and clear to produce good quality photocopies.
- The first page of each paper should consist of the paper details and the rubric as illustrated on the template. The examination questions should always begin on page 2.
- Each page must be numbered clearly.
- Use only one side of the paper when printing the examination paper.
- The course code of the examination paper should be typed in full (eg EC111-1-FY) on the top right-hand corner of EACH page.
- A question should not be split across two pages, the whole question should appear on the same page. This is particularly important for examination papers for students with individual needs.
- Questions should be numbered consecutively throughout. Do not revert to question No. 1 at the beginning of a new section.
- Multi-part questions (eg: 1a, 1b, 1c i), ii).....) can often contain errors which disrupt examinations when they need to be checked, especially when questions cross-reference the different parts. Please take extra care to check the numbering of multi-part questions, especially if using the MS Word auto-number tool.
- On the last page, please type 'END OF PAPER' immediately after the last question.
- Graphs, diagrams, maps, tables etc. must be originals and suitable for photocopying. They must either be incorporated in the typescript OR if they are to appear as separate sheets, they must be in A4 format and bear the paper number and must identify clearly the question to which the item refers.
- If any materials cannot successfully be photocopied, eg: photographs, they must be supplied in sufficient quantities by the department.
- The master copies provided to the Exams Office should NOT be stapled together.
- Completed papers must be delivered by hand, marked 'CONFIDENTIAL' and given personally to one of the Examination and Timetable Office staff. They should not be posted or left with anyone else. You will be asked to sign an Examination Paper receipt log upon delivery.

(SC301-3-FY SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III: CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY)

3rd Year Examinations 2005

**SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III: CURRENT DISPUTES IN
SOCIOLOGY**

Time allowed: 3 hours

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions

The paper consists of 12 questions

Please do not leave your seat unless you are given permission by an Invigilator.
Do not communicate in any way with any other candidate in the examination room.
Do not open the question paper until told to do so.
All answers must be written in the answer book(s) provided.
All rough work must be written in the answer book(s) provided. A line should be
drawn through any rough work to indicate to the examiner that it is not part of the
work to be marked.
At the end of the examination, remain seated until your answer book(s) have been
collected and you have been told you may leave.

(SC301-3 – FY SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III: CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY)

1. Assess the value of recent feminist post-structural approaches to the study of gender, such as Judith Butler's concept of 'performativity'.

2. **Either:** What are the main disagreements driving the debate around the notion of an 'information society'?

Or: What is 'immaterial labour'? How useful is this concept in highlighting changes in the mode of production?

3. Discuss the shift from 'structures' to 'flows, networks and mobilities' in recent sociological theory.

4. **Either:** Are we (still) living in a post-modern culture? Discuss by drawing on the work of key theorists such as Fredric Jameson and Jean Baudrillard.

Or: Which of the following terms best characterises contemporary western societies?
 - a. Postmodernity
 - b. Reflexive modernity
 - c. Late capitalism

5. How is cultural identity formed according to cultural studies theorists such as Stuart Hall?

6. **Either:** Discuss Habermas' notion of the public sphere and its relevance in understanding contemporary debates on the role of communication in modern societies.

Or: In his early writing Habermas presented the idea of a critical social theory aimed at achieving human emancipation. Is this a justifiable view of the role of sociology?

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7. How is it possible to understand a culture that is radically different from one's own?
8. 'Although positivism is open to some serious criticisms, it still has much to offer as an approach to social research.' Discuss.
9. Some critical realists argue that there are fundamental differences between natural and social processes but that it is still possible to study social life in a scientific way. How strong are their arguments for this?
10. How successful is the postmodernist critique of sociological concepts of 'society'? You may answer with reference to one postmodernist writer.
11. How effective is Foucault's writing on power as a challenge to classical Marxism?
12. Give a critical assessment of any one attempt to develop a feminist epistemology.

(END OF PAPER)